

Thad and Liz Thomas's Tale

(as related to Fiona Leslie: Feb 2014)

It was 1971. Quadrant's large signs dotted the shoulders of Highway 2 touting a paradise on Harstine Island. Liz took the bait and turned off the State Road onto Pickering. Following the directions, she crossed over the bridge and took a left at the T junction onto a twist, bumpy graveled road. Hartstene Pointe was gated, but the bar was raised. Driving on through she saw a clubhouse, and Olympic sized unfenced pool and to her left, tennis courts. The road was unpaved. She couldn't get farther than Barbary.



Further North was an undeveloped forest of second growth fir, cedar and hemlock. The underbrush was dense with large fern, salal, Oregon grape, and huckleberry bushes. Eagles circled above the trees and deer were munching on berries. There were stretches of long sandy beaches with oysters, clams and mussels according to the sales pitch. You could troll or fly fish and easily catch your salmon limit.

Liz was sold. This truly was paradise. Interior circular lots were \$6,000. Attracted to Pitcairn Road, they erected a Lumberman's home on the site. Their family was to spend many weekends and vacations on Hartstene Pointe. They loved it.

By 1988 it was time to retire and they built a larger home on Pointes Drive East. After spending 45 years on the Pointe, they have never regretted their decision.

Thad and Liz were tireless volunteers. Thad earned the Volunteer of the Year award, was elected to the Board and has been an actively vocal participant in meetings. Liz led many hiking groups around the Pointe and identified trees and plants on the Nature Trail.

Sadly they now have their house for sale as living closer to health care services has become a priority. They will be greatly missed, not only by their friends and neighbors, but by Harstine Islanders, too.